



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's find out about jet lag!



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What's the farthest place you have ever visited?
- Do you adjust quickly when traveling? Explain.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about health and wellness.
- I can point out the reason of an action or an event.
- I can skim a text for important information.





Let's Explore!

How does jet lag affect your **circadian*** rhythm?

* "Circadian" means anything relating to the regular changes in a person that happen in 24-hour periods.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Seasoned travelers know all too well the feeling of being wide awake, suddenly, at 2:00 a.m., and then feeling dead tired at 2:00 p.m. These extreme shifts in energy are the effects of jet lag, which occurs due to changes in your body's circadian rhythms. Jet lag, known medically as desynchronization, generally manifests itself as trouble falling asleep when traveling east, and trouble waking up when traveling west. Other symptoms can include fatigue, poor concentration, headaches, irritability and often indigestion.

Jet lag can affect each person differently; however, a good rule of thumb is that one day of recovery is required for each hour of time difference between the city of departure and the destination. That means if you travel from Toronto to Frankfurt, you will need six days to fully recover, owing to the fact that Frankfurt is six hours ahead of Toronto. If you travel from Bogota to New Delhi, the adjustment period will be more like ten days. Los Angeles to Miami? Just three days.

There are several effective remedies for jet lag. The first is avoiding bright light, especially in the morning. Due to the fact that it is produced in dim light, the hormone melatonin can also be taken as a supplement to help combat the effects of jet lag. Finally, there are special glasses that can be worn to provide extra light at specific intervals. Owing to the possibility of accidents caused by jet lag, most airline pilots and crew must complete a mandatory rest period before moving from one destination to another.

What's the very best way to avoid jet lag? Traveling north-south, of course! That's because of the fact that jet lag only affects those traveling east-west, across time zones. So next time you plan a trip from Cairo, think about flying south to Johannesburg, not east to Beijing.



Let's Practice!

Travel can be hard on the body!

Instructions: Circle all the words used to point out the reason for an event. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. These extreme shifts in energy are the effects of jet lag, which occurs due to changes to your body's circadian rhythms.
2. If you travel from Toronto to Frankfurt, you will need six days to fully recover, owing to the fact that Frankfurt is six hours ahead of Toronto.
3. Due to the fact that it is produced in dim light, the hormone melatonin can also be taken as a supplement to help combat the effects of jet lag.
4. Owing to the possibility of accidents caused by jet lag, most airline pilots and crew must complete a mandatory rest period before moving from one destination to another.
5. That's because of the fact that jet lag only affects those traveling east-west, across time zones.



Let's Practice!

Have you ever been jet-lagged?

Instructions: Classify the words into the given categories.

wide awake

irritability

fatigue

headaches

dead tired

indigestion

seasoned

poor concentration

Adjectives to Describe a Person

Words to Describe Symptoms



Extension Activity

Make a jet lag chart.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Find the travel time between your hometown and the following destinations: Brisbane, Tokyo, Berlin, Moscow, Santiago, San Francisco, Toronto, Nairobi and Tehran.
- Based on what you know about jet lag, find out how long it would take to adjust if you traveled to each of these destinations.
- Put your findings into chart form.
- Explain your chart to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research travel time.

☐ ☐

I create a jet lag chart.

☐ ☐

I present my findings to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **wide awake** (expression): fully awake or alert
e.g. Seasoned travelers know all too well the feeling of being wide awake, suddenly, at 2:00 a.m., and then feeling dead tired at 2:00 p.m.
- **dead tired** (expression): extremely tired; exhausted
e.g. I was dead tired after taking the overnight flight to Frankfurt.
- **fatigue** (noun): tiredness
e.g. Other symptoms can include fatigue, poor concentration and headaches.
- **irritability** (noun): the state of being easily annoyed or sensitive
e.g. Irritability is also a symptom of fatigue.
- **indigestion** (noun): difficulty digesting food
e.g. Some travelers may experience indigestion.
- **rule of thumb** (expression): an unofficial rule or guiding principle
e.g. Jet lag can affect each person differently; however, a good rule of thumb is that one day of recovery is required for each hour of time difference between the city of departure and the destination.





Learning Points

Giving Reasons: Because of, Due to, Owing to

You use reason clauses to express the reasons for an action, or why a situation is the way it is.

You use words like *because of*, *due to*, and *owing to* to introduce a noun phrase to give a reason for something.

Reason clauses are subordinate to the main clause. They state the reason why things are done, or what makes a situation the way it is.

You can use *because of*, *due to* or *owing to* to introduce a noun phrase that gives a reason for a situation.

Example:

*She was injured **because of** an accident.*

*We have less money **owing to** / **due to** budget cuts.*

Read the following examples from the text:

Examples:

- *These extreme shifts in energy are the effects of jet lag, which occurs due to changes to your body's circadian rhythms.*
- *If you travel from Toronto to Frankfurt, you will need six days to fully recover, owing to the fact that Frankfurt is six hours ahead of Toronto.*
- *Due to the fact that it is produced in dim light, the hormone melatonin can also be taken as a supplement to help combat the effects of jet lag.*
- *Owing to the possibility of accidents caused by jet lag, most airline pilots and crew must complete a mandatory rest period before moving from one destination to another.*
- *That's because of the fact that jet lag only affects those traveling east-west, across time zones.*





Learning Points

Skimming a Text

Skimming and scanning are two very different strategies for reading texts quickly and for getting the information you need from them without wasting time. Knowing when to use these skills will help with your reading abilities and comprehension skills.

Skimming:

Skimming refers to looking only for the **general or main ideas** in a text. When you skim, your overall understanding is reduced because **you don't read everything**. You read only what is important to your purpose. One technique for effective skimming is **reading only the first line of each paragraph**, since these are the topic sentences and will give you an idea of what the main idea of each paragraph is.

For example:

*These extreme shifts in energy are the effects of jet lag.
Jet lag can affect each person differently.
There are several effective remedies for jet lag.
What's the very best way to avoid jet lag?*

Scanning:

Scanning refers to looking for **specific information** in a text. Examples of scanning in daily life are: bus schedules, movie schedules, phone lists etc. When you use these kinds of texts, you are only looking for a specific detail (a number, a date, a name etc.).

Knowing the structure of the text you want to scan will help you do it quickly (alphabetical, numerical, chronological or by category).

Try skimming and scanning the text for the general ideas and for specifics.

For example:

*Other symptoms can include fatigue, poor concentration, headaches, irritability and often indigestion.
That means if you travel from Toronto to Frankfurt, you will need six days to fully recover, owing to the fact that Frankfurt is six hours ahead of Toronto.
That's because of the fact that jet lag only affects those traveling east-west, across time zones.*

